



Ironclad
asset management

Ironclad Ventures Fund (Cat 1 AIF)

Private & Confidential
Not for circulation

Ironclad Ventures is an early secondaries fund targeted at portfolio of top 10-15 VCs



The Problem

Early-stage employees lack belief in ESOP of startups

Angels and early investors have limited exit pathways till pre-IPO

Our Solution

Structured partial liquidity for vested ESOPs & early angels / investors

The Result

Enhanced retention and easier senior hires for companies + easier exits for Angels

Entry into top tier VC funded cap tables for our LPs

30-40

Portfolio Companies

Diversified exposure across top-tier sectors

10-15

Top Tier VCs' Portfolio startups

80%+ portfolio will be from portfolio of top tier VCs

30%+

Target IRR

Venture-style returns with compressed holding periods

\$100K

Minimum Investment (\$2-5k/startup)

Low-ticket entry into premium cap tables

Investing in VC backed Series A startups is very different from angel / seed investing

Angel / Pre-Seed Investing



Thousands of hopefuls. Almost impossible to pick the winner.

- ⚠️ **Unfiltered field** — no institutional validation, anyone can enter
- ⚠️ **Hard to identify winners** — 80%+ angel / pre-seed bets never reach Series A
- ⚠️ **Undercapitalized** — no follow-on muscle to fund the journey to scale

Top VC-Backed Series A Startups



Only founders who cleared India's toughest filter compete here.

- ✓ **Funded journey** — top VCs back winners all the way to IPO
- ✓ **Elite founders** — top tier founders with Stellar work experience + academic backgrounds
- ✓ **Proven PMF** — Series A means real revenue, real traction

3 Key advantages in going into a funded Series A startup vs. early-stage angel investing :

- 1. Funded journey :** VCs back winners till IPO / growth rounds
- 2. Better quality of team:** Stellar work-ex + academics in most funded startups with some next level team also visible
- 3. Product market fit :** real customer adoption, real revenue with early economics starts to become visible

✨ India's Top 10-15 VC Funds have backed 70%+ of all Unicorns in India. Ironclad invests alongside them in top startups. ✨

Multiple pathways to enter India's best funded startups at A/B Stage



ESOP Secondaries

Turning paper wealth into real wealth

- We partner with founders / companies to purchase 20–40% of vested ESOPs. Partial liquidity in 1st / 2nd year of vesting reinforces credibility of ESOPs and signals real wealth creation
- Better retention of senior talent, reduced cash burn on salaries, more mission-driven employees — with zero new dilution.
- Typical cheque size ranges from Rs. 10L to Rs. 30L per employee. Typically done for 3-5 senior employees at a time.

Example: VP Eng at VC backed fintech (₹300Cr Series A). Ironclad purchases 30% of vested ESOPs for ₹35L cash. Employee retains 70% upside. Company retains key hire.

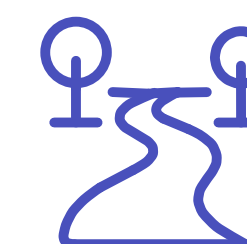


Angel Secondaries

Liquidity for early believers, access for Ironclad

- India has 50,000+ active angels who backed thousands of startups in 2021–24. The Series A/B cohort of 2026–28 represents their winners — but stakes remain illiquid.
- We acquire 20–100% of angel holdings at fair valuations, giving them partial exits while they retain meaningful upside.
- Win for angels: Crystallize 8–15x gains on holdings without waiting 5+ years for IPO or acquisition.

Example: Angel invested ₹20L at ₹20Cr in 2021. A leading VC leads Series A at ₹200Cr. Ironclad buys 30% of angel's stake for say ₹50L — angel books 8x on partial exit, takes cost ++ out while keeping his remaining upside.



Other Entry Routes

Flexible access, consistent mandate

- Direct co-investments: When allocation is available in rounds led by top VCs, Ironclad participates as a direct co-investor alongside the lead.
- Advisor & early employee secondaries: Purchases from advisors, founding team members/founders, or other early stakeholders seeking partial liquidity.

Retain the core texture of 80%+ investments in startups backed by top tier VC's, irrespective of entry pathway

We do secondaries in portfolio of top 10-15 VCs only as they are responsible for ~75%+ of ~100 unicorns in India

Company	Valuation(\$B)	Top 10 VC Fund investment
 Flipkart	35.0	✓
 zomato	23.7	✓
 paytm	5.6	✓
 oyo	4.6	✓
 DREAM11	8.0	✓
 OLA	2.1	✓
 Razorpay	8.0	✓
 OLA ELECTRIC	2.9	✓
 SWIGGY	9.6	✓
 PhonePe	12.0	✓
 meesho	3.9	✓
 CRED	6.4	✓
 digit	3.8	✓
 unacademy	3.4	✓
 udaan	1.8	✓
 DELHIVERY	2.3	✓
 Groww	3.0	✓
 ShareChat	4.9	✓
 of business	2.8	✓
 BharatPe	2.8	✓
 lenskart	5.6	✓

Company	Valuation(\$B)	Top 10 VC Fund investment
 INFRA.MARKET	2.8	✓
 MPL	2.2	✓
 NYKAA	6.7	✓
 policybazaar	8.5	✓
 freshworks	4.8	✓
 mamaearth	1.0	✓
 MobiKwik	1.7	✓
 ixigo	0.7	✓
 firstcity	1.8	✓
 one card	1.4	✓
 oxyzo	1.0	✓
 uc Urban Company	2.5	✓
 ACKO	1.4	✓
 make my trip	11.4	✓
 ZOHIO	14.0	✓
 ZERODHA	3.6	✓
 netcore	1.0	✓

Top 10-15 VC funds have ~75% of the ~100 unicorns among themselves

At a company level, top startups return 5x to 50x+ from Series A valuations

	Series A Valuation (\$M)	Current Valuation (\$M)	Company level valuation markup	Post dilution Series A investor returns (Ironclad Estimates)	Time from Series A to last round
 Groww	40	7000	~175x	~65x	~6 yrs
 ZETWERK	33	3000	~90x	~25x	~6 yrs
 BharatPe	58	3000	~50x	~25x	~4 yrs
 Spinny	25	1500	~60x	~31x	~4 yrs
 INFRA. MARKET	80	2500	~30x	~14x	~5 yrs
 smallcase	40	350	~9x	~6x	~2.5 yrs
 mosaic WELLNESS	11	250	~22x	~14x	~4.5 yrs
 HASURA	50	1000	~20x	~12x	~3 yrs

Best VC's make much better return than average angel investors as :

1. VCs have large \$500M to \$2Bn India dedicated funds + relationships with larger funds
2. They bring in the ecosystem to help grow startups (e.g. help in hiring, understand best practices, GTM, etc)
3. Best founders want to work with best VCs

VCs make portfolio level ~7-8x+ returns on Seed/Series A investments even after accounting for startup shutdowns and dilution

Stage	% Success (\$200m+ valuation)	Returns at Portfolio level	Avg Valuation Entry	Indicative List of sector defining companies Company (Entry, Exit)		
Seed	~20%	12-15x	Rs. 50 Crs	 POSTMAN (<\$10m, \$5Bn)	 Urban Company (<\$10m, \$2.5Bn)	 Jumbotail (<\$10m, \$0.9Bn)
				 Razorpay (<\$10m, \$8Bn)	 ACKO (<\$10m, \$1.4Bn)	 ZETWERK MAXIMIZE MANUFACTURING (<\$10m, \$3.0Bn)
Series A	~40%	7-8x	Rs. 150 Crs	 mamaearth TM (~\$15m, \$1Bn)	 Spinny [®] (<\$30m, \$1.7Bn)	 PORTER [®] (~\$15m, \$1.2Bn)
				 SWIGGY (~\$5m, \$13Bn)	 meesho (~\$10m, \$3.9Bn)	 MPL MOBILE PREMIER LEAGUE (~\$100m, \$2.0Bn)
Series B	~50%	3-5x	Rs. 500 Crs	 MobiKwik (<\$10m, \$0.3Bn)	 blinkit (~\$100m, \$1.0Bn)	 cloudnine (<\$20m, \$0.4Bn)
Fund Performance		~7-8x+ MOIC ~40%+ IRRs		 INDIGO PAINTS (<\$50m, \$0.6Bn)	 K12 (<\$20m, \$0.5Bn)	

Best VC's have a flywheel working for them !



Exceptional Founder Access

Powerful brand : Top funds have a powerful brand & reputation that makes it the top choice for elite founders. Strong reputation gives them early access to the best startups.

Referrals from founders : Funded founders, who in future become angel investors or repeat founders within their network. Winning founders return to Top funds for their next venture.

Understanding of space : Senior team members at VCs are highly influential with deep access in tech circle, giving them understanding of the space



Access to capital for follow-on

- **Large fund size** : Having large \$600M-\$1B funds allow Top5 VCs to actively follow its winners across multiple funding rounds, consistently doubling down on high-performing bets.
- **Relationship with growth equity funds:**□ Top funds maintain strong relationships with major growth equity funds with deeper pockets like sovereign wealth funds, crossover investors, and public market investors (Tiger Global, Coatue, SoftBank, frequently co-invest or lead follow-on rounds in startups from Top VCs). Growth funds frequently track portfolios of TopVCs, recognizing them as strong pipelines for scalable startups.



Active support

- **Talent hiring & support** : VC's have dedicated Talent Advisory Team that helps portfolio companies source talent for CXOs, VP-level leaders, and top engineers along with providing compensation benchmarking.
- **Go-to-Market (GTM) Strategy & Sales Support** : Most VCs have playbooks on sales motion, pricing models, and customer acquisition. They also provide access to their network of enterprise buyers and Fortune 500 companies particularly for SaaS, fintech, and AI startups

It is extremely hard to get into Top VC fund’s LP base; needs \$25M+ commitment across 2-3 funds

	Top Tier VC Fund	Why it different with Ironclad EEF ?
Issue #1 : Individuals vs Institutions	Raises only from large pension funds , SWF, etc	Raising from HNI individuals
Issue #2 : Minimum commitment	\$25M per fund for 2-3 funds; implies \$50-100M total exposure to a fund	Rs. 1Cr and above
Issue #3 : # of years fund cycle	7 to 12 yrs <i>(Invest from Seed and stay till post IPO)</i>	2 to 4 yrs <i>(invest at Series A and plan to exit at Series C / D)</i>
Underlying investments in both would be the same companies opening access to top tech startups to Indian individual investors		

CNBC

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Venture firm Sequoia is building a \$12 billion war chest after SoftBank raises stakes



Michael Moritz, chairman at Sequoia Capital
Scott Mlyn / CNBC

Sequoia, the venture capital firm known for early bets on everything from [Apple](#) and [Google](#) to WhatsApp and Dropbox, is setting a high bar to get into its upcoming global growth fund: \$250 million.

That’s the minimum check size required for limited partners to participate in the fund, which is aiming to raise up to \$8 billion, said sources familiar with the matter who asked not to be named because the fundraising is confidential.

Sources told CNBC that amount is three to four times bigger than what top funds typically get from their biggest limited partners.

Sequoia, long considered the gold standard among venture firms, is holding its annual meeting for existing investors in Beijing in mid-April, sources said, as China becomes a bigger emphasis. The event is typically held in San Francisco, though the firm has held one previous meeting in Beijing.

Beyond the VC Co-investor signal : Look at 4 things to build conviction



Segment Leadership

- Winners keep winning — we want to be on the right side
- Startups should be a Top 3-4 player in its segment
- Competitive moat & revenue retention as real traction signals
- Distinguishing sustainable growth from vanity metrics



Valuation & Risk adjusted entry price

- Tentative entry price relative to Series A valuation (discount is any)
- Price relative to scale achieved since raise (implied discount accounting for scale up)
- Not the primary filter, but a meaningful margin-of-safety check
- What is level of inbound requests for company for future fund raise



Scale-Up Momentum (Post Series A/B)

- What has the trajectory looked like since Series A/B?
- We typically enter 3–9 months post A/B term sheet, so have post funding momentum to track as health indicator (source of significant advantage)
- TAM gets stress-tested: did more capital scale revenue? Did product / processes scale with it ?



Founder Fit & Comfort

- Strength of the next leadership layer built
- Pedigree: past work-ex, domain wins, relationship with primary VC, execution track record
- ESOP philosophy: is wealth creation broad-based for the team?

Exit : Focused towards returning capital quickly

Entry

Focus : Series A / Early Series B

Hold Period

~4–5 years

(Duration compression vs traditional 10–12 year VC)

Exit

Series D / E or Pre-IPO

(we do not want to wait the full cycle in most companies)

Secondary to Growth Funds

- Sale into late-stage funding rounds
- Crossover / growth equity buyers

Pre-IPO Secondary Market / IPO

- Wealth platforms accumulating inventory
- Block placements prior to listing
- Post list market sale

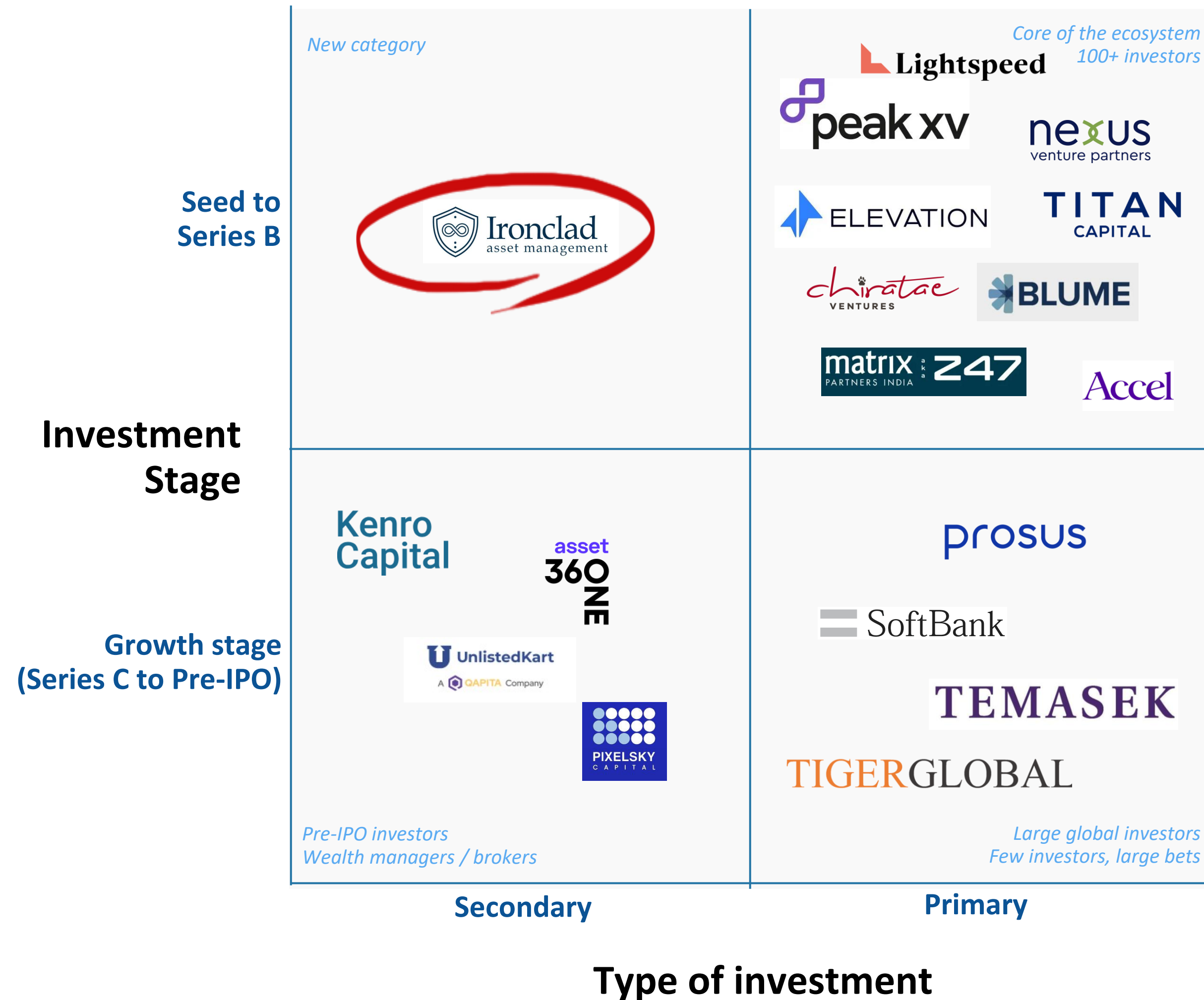
Strategic / Corporate Acquisitions

- Sector consolidation
- Trade sales

Why Liquidity Is Structurally Easier for Ironclad Ventures

- Small ownership stakes (<1%)
- \$5–25M equivalent positions vs \$300M+ VC positions who own 10-20% of company
- No signaling obligation as non-lead investor
- Diversified portfolio reduces single-exit dependence
- Can sell in tranches starting from Series D/E onwards to de-risk

Ironclad operates in a unique investing space



Two key aspects of white space identified by Ironclad

1. The need for companies to get a provider of secondary capital in early stage is very high
2. There is almost NO provider of secondary capital at this early stage.

Ironclad Ventures : An “Index fund” type approach to early-stage investing

We are looking to invest in companies funded by
larger VC's at Seed/ Series A stage

Sector	Fintech	Consumer Tech	AI Tech	Others (Climate, Healthcare, Gaming, Deeptech)
Type of investment	Employee Secondary		Angel / Other Secondary	Primary
Geography	India			Others (US, EU, SEA)
Strategy	Co-invest with larger funds (VCs, PEs)			Lead
Ticket size	Upto 2crs		2 – 4 crs	4Crs+
Stage	Seed	Series A		Series B + Growth

Bulk of the investment will be in 3 core sectors

~70% allocation to core sectors; forms ~60% of VC \$s invested as well



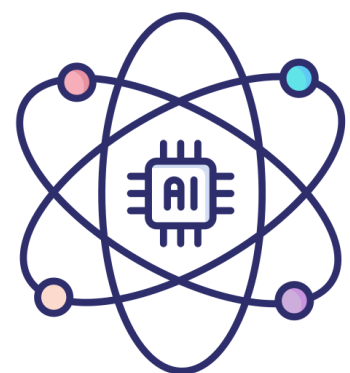
Fintech

- Compelling due to India's massive underfinanced population, increasing digital adoption, and a robust public digital infrastructure (like UPI and Aadhaar)
- Includes lending, insurtech, wealthtech, neobanking, infra-layer fintech
- Accounts for ~25% of total VC capital deployed in India annually
- High ESOP participation, frequent rounds make it well suited for Ironclad



Consumer

- Growing internet user base, increasing disposable income, and quick commerce driving explosive growth in consumer-facing digital businesses.
- Covers consumer brands, Q-commerce, D2C, marketplaces
- Accounts for ~20% of total VC capital deployed in India annually
- Sector with most strategic exits via sale to larger brands, constant need to hire top talent from MNC's via ESOPs make it a focus vertical for Ironclad



AI & SaaS Technology

- Indian startups increasingly building for global markets, leveraging skilled, cost-effective tech talent pool.
- Focus on recurring revenue models
- ~15% of capital deployed, but rapidly growing share
- High cost deep tech talent make ESOP participation a necessity

~20-30% opportunistic allocation



Deeptech



Gaming



Health tech



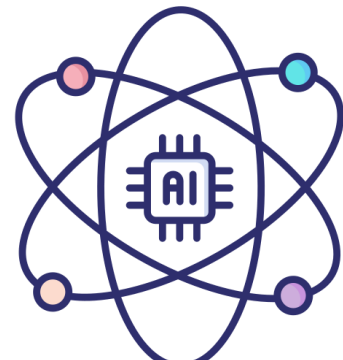
Climate



Travel tech

And other sectors..

Healthy pipeline across sectors in startups backed by top VCs

	Company	Stage & Investors	Description	Deployment	
	Fintech	Supply chain finance	Series A 1 of top 5 VCs	Integrated solutions for accounts payable automation, supply chain financing, and vendor payments.	~2.0Cr Secondary
		Financial products for salaried	Series A 1 of top 5 VCs	Fintech platform providing salary-linked financial products and services	~2.0Cr Secondary
		Retail wealth	Growth	Retail and Affluent wealth management	~4.0Cr Secondary
		Investment Tech	Series B 1 of top 5 VCs	Online platform for fixed-income bond investments	~3.0Cr Secondary
	Consumer	D2C Personal Care	Series A Top 10 VCs + Top CGP	Internet-first brand of multi category beauty care products	~1.5Cr Secondary
		Consumer products	Seed Top 15 VCs	Early stage company specializing in pain management products	~1.0Cr Primary
		Healthy Snacks	Series B Top 5 VCs	Online platform offering healthy snacks and beverages	~1.0Cr Primary
	Technology	AI platform	Seed top 20 VC	AI-powered photo editing platform	~2.0Cr Secondary
		Agentic AI	Series A top 5 VCs	AI-powered speech analytics and AI agent solutions for BFSI	~2.0Cr Secondary
		ESDM Company	Series A	Platform offering electric vehicle powertrain products and electronic design manufacturing services	~2.5Cr Direct
	Others	Fitness tech	Seed Top 10 VC	Provider of a vagus nerve stimulation device for stress and anxiety reduction	~1.0Cr Primary
		EdTech	Series A Top 5 Global Edtech VC	Tech enabled provider of admission services for colleges globally	~1.5Cr Secondary
		Real estate Tech	Series A 1 of top 5 VCs	Digital, end-to-end customer experience that makes buying and selling of home simple, certain, and fast	~2.0Cr Primary

Experience across investing and startup; well connected within ecosystem



Krishna Killa,
Founder

- Founder of Ironclad AMC, a public market long only investment firm
- Established Ironclad AMC by building a proprietary investment strategy which prioritizes capital preservation in a FlexiCap investing approach



- Worked as Investment Professional at Bain Capital Private Equity, one of the top Private Equity investors in world with \$100B+ in Investments



- Founded and scaled healthtech company - LifCare, scaling across India, raising over Rs. 100Cr from leading institutional investors like Elevation Capital, Nexus Venture Partners, KOIS Capital and IIFL



- Worked as Strategy Consultant at Boston Consulting Group (BCG), one of the top 2 management consulting companies in the world.



- Chartered Accountant with All India Rank 14, Undergrad from St. Xavier's College, Kolkata
- Guest speaker at Harvard Business School, USA; Goldman Sachs TechNet Conference, Hong Kong; TiE Innovation Summit, New Delhi

Top Tier VC Investors, Proven Operators — helping source and help Investment @ Ironclad Ventures as Advisors



Arpit Maheshwari

- Principal, Stellaris Venture Partners (2018-2024)
- Invested in AI/ SaaS @ Stellaris
- Stellaris is a top 10 VC firm in India
- Education : IIT Delhi, IIM A



Apurva Chamaria

- Global Head of Venture Capital & Startups @ Google
- Founder of AC Ventures, a syndicate for early stage investing
- Education : IIT Delhi, HBS



Gaurav Kedia

- Prolific angel investor; backed Fresh from Farm (14x), Kazam (10x), Samosa Party (5x), Stage OTT(5x), Ishitva(6x), Qubehealth(6x), Vested, Perfora, BonV Aero, etc as angel investor
- ex-Merrill Lynch I-banker
- Education : IIM B, CA (AIR24)



Shrey Badhani

- Co-Founder of Kapiva Ayurveda – D2C ayurvedic healthcare and nutritional products company
- Raised \$50M; ~\$200M valuation
- Education : LSE



Fund Terms

Stage of Investment	Seed / Series A / Series B depending on company size & valuation Rs. 2-4Cr s per company; across 25-40 companies 70-80% portfolio to be at early stage alongside a top VC tech fund
Target Fund Size	Rs. 100Cr s (Current fund raise) + Rs. 100Cr (Greenshoe for raise in subsequent years)
Target IRR	30%+ <i>Target returns are what Seed/Series A investments of top funds have in past yielded. Actual performance may differ materially and is not assured.</i>
Fund Structure	Cat 1 AIF (Angel Structure)
Duration	8+2 Yrs <i>We will endeavor to exit cos in 4-5 yr from investment</i>
Investment Amount	Rs. 1Cr and above; <i>10% cheque at commitment; Remaining 90% expected to be called Rs. 10L per quarter over next 2-3Yrs</i>
Other details	Please refer Private Placement Memorandum for full details like deployment schedule, Fees, setup costs, tax and regulatory structure, operating expenses, governance structure, etc.

Committed capital to be invested over a period of ~2-3yrs

Total commitment (Rs. in lacs)	100
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	Year 1					Year 2				Year 3	Total
	On commitment	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	
Amount (Rs. in lacs)	10	10	10	10	10	10	10	10	10	10	100

- Investments are expected to be made over a ~2 to 3 Yr period (depending on investment pipeline / market conditions)
- Capital gets called-in over the tenure of investment and not immediately at commitment
- There is a ~15 days call period over which capital needs to be invested from the call date

Contact Details



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Annexures

Working with India's leading financial service providers to be fully compliant & ensure safety of assets



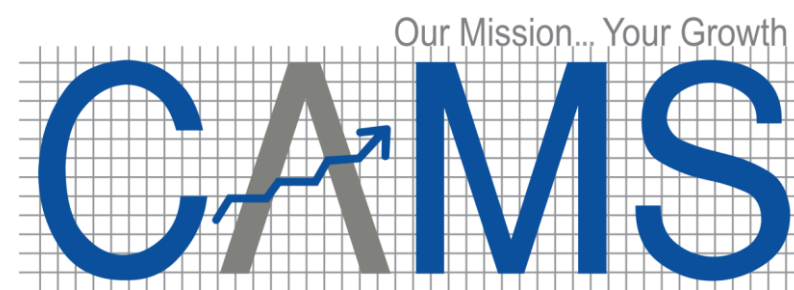
- SEBI Cat 1 Fund. Registration No. IN/AIF1/25-26/1899
- This is our 2nd registration with SEBI after Portfolio Management (Registration No. PM / INP000009074)



- Custody Service from ICICI Bank, India's top Private Bank
- Shares are held in in Custody Account with ICICI Bank
- All the money is held in ICICI Bank fund account



- Fund accounting with ICICI Bank
- Monthly reports, NAV calculation , fee calculation and disbursal



- RTA services from CAMS
- Fund setup, unit allotment, Statement of account, Statement of holding, drawdown notices, MIS reporting, transfers etc.



- Trusteeship with Vardhman Trusteeship
- One of the top 20 trustees in country

Periodic reporting to ensure full transparency

Periodic Performance statement

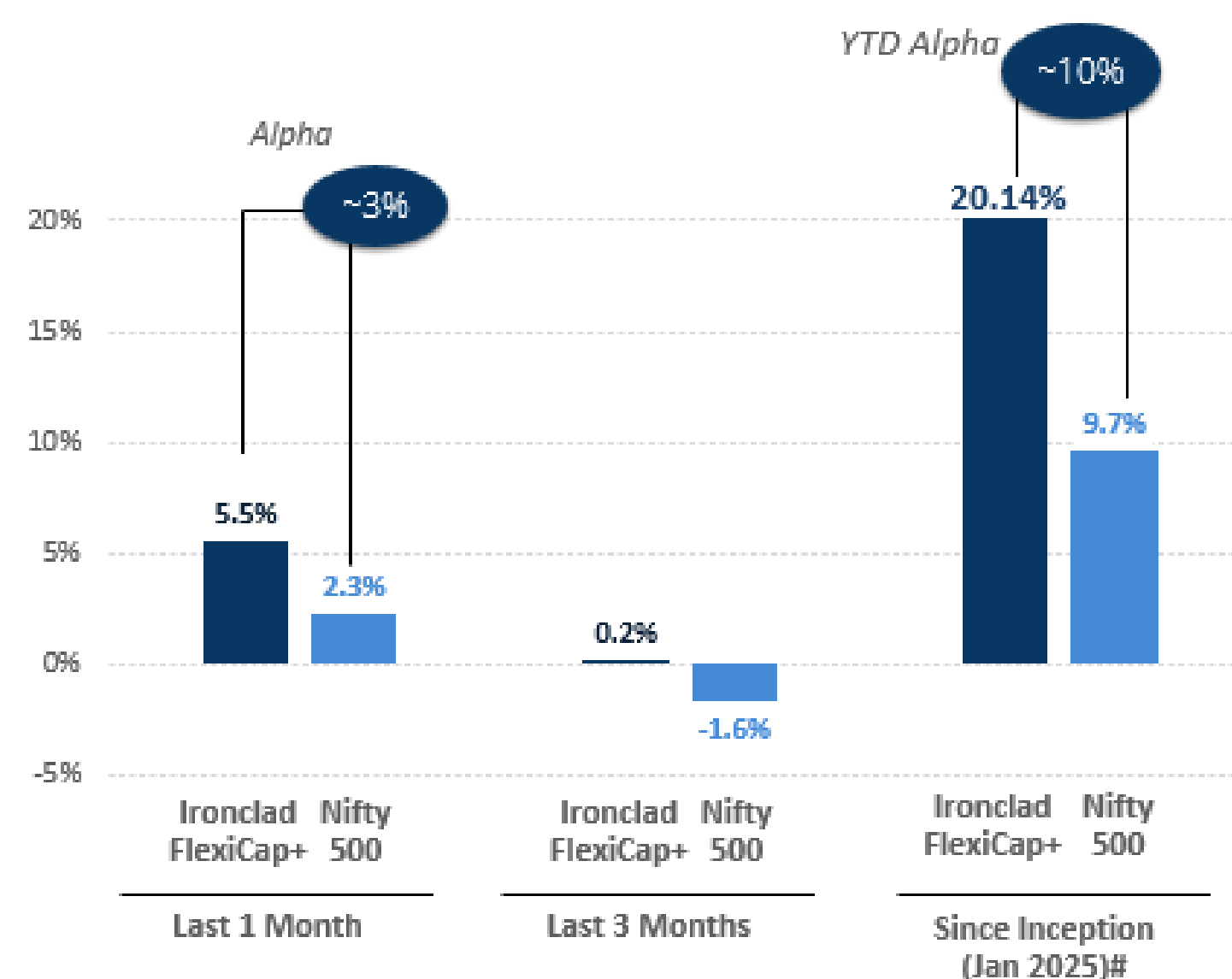
Holding reports at monthly intervals

Audited Statements at year end

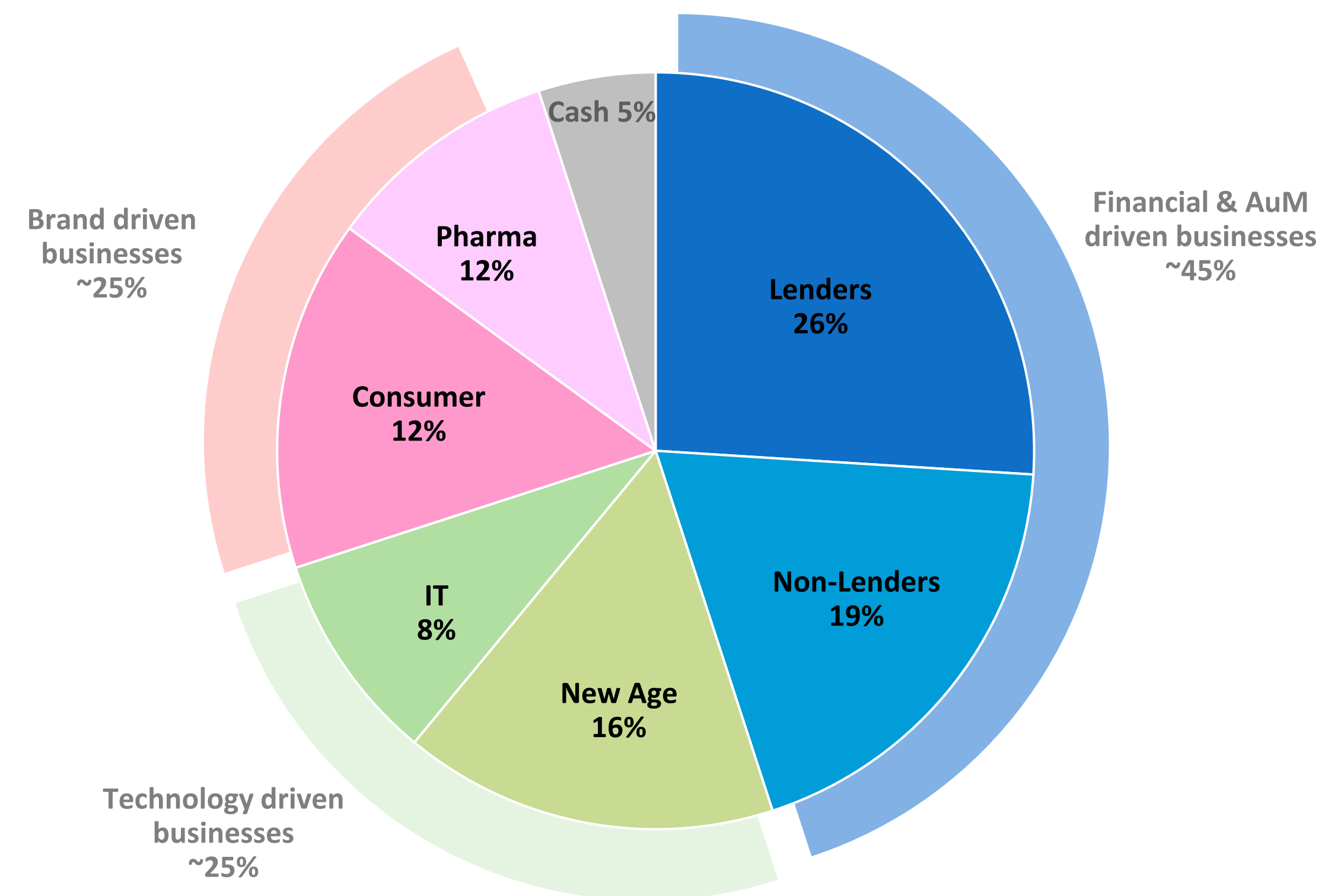
Ironclad AMC is an existing public market investment firm (SEBI Registered PMS)

Entering early stage investing with Venture capital fund

**Outperformed Nifty 500 by ~10%+
in a difficult / volatile market**



Sector wise % allocation in public markets for Ironclad Flexicap+ Scheme (PMS)



**Sectoral allocation very similar to the
“Core Sectors” in Venture fund**

Indian startup ecosystem is large and growing

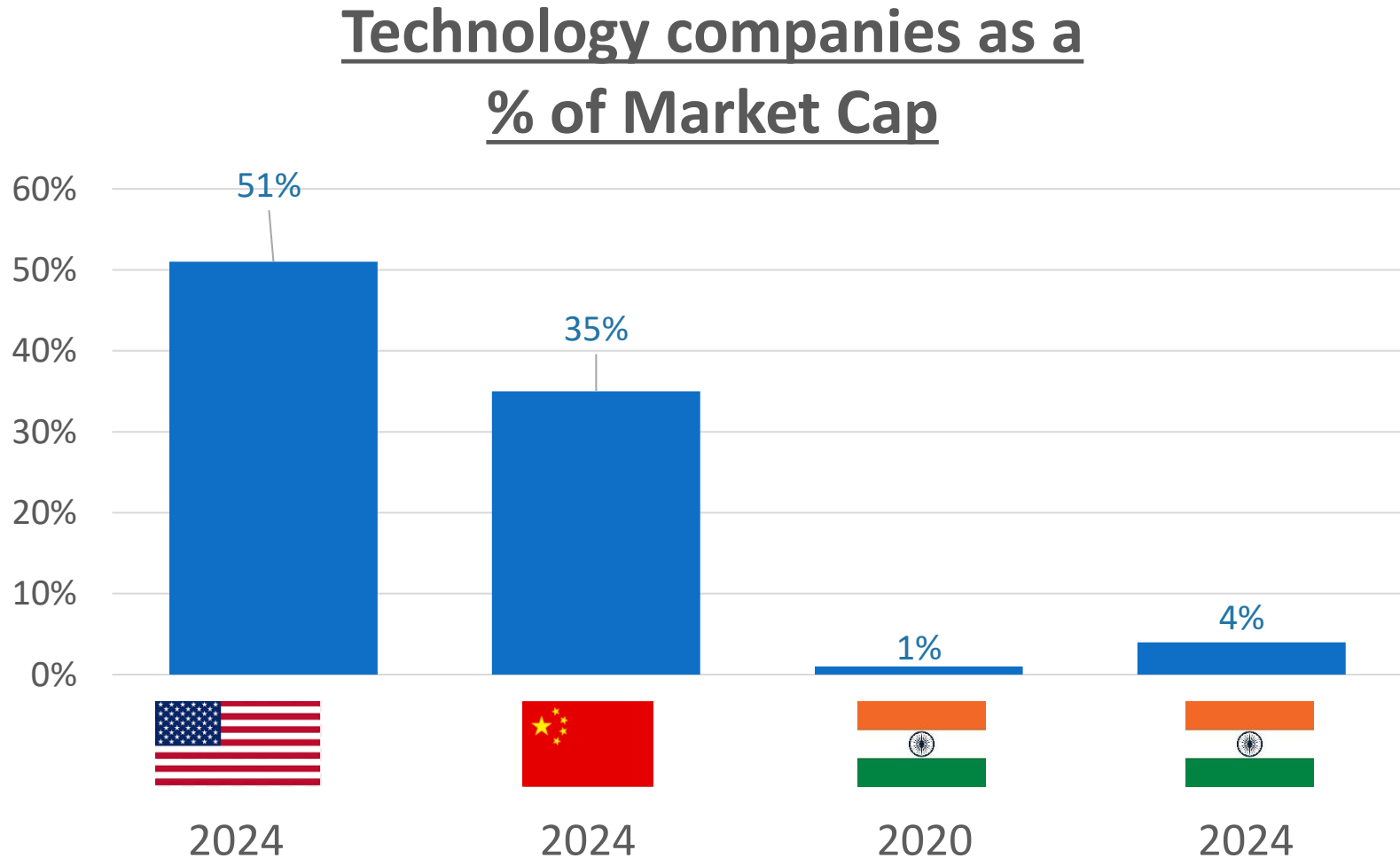
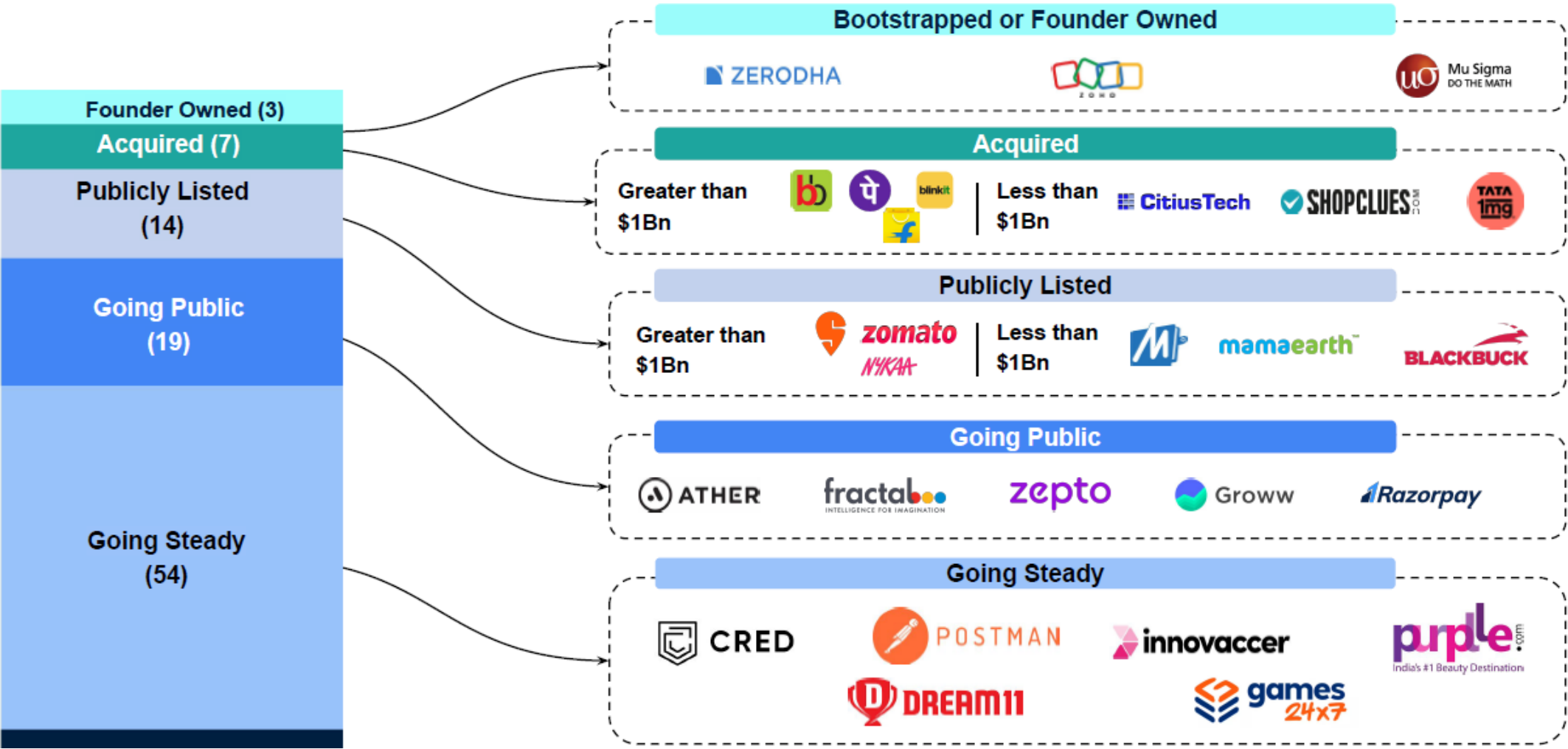
	2024	2030	% Growth (Absolute)
Smartphone Users	1 Bn+	1.5 Bn+	50%
Internet Users	886 Mn+	1.2 Bn+	35%
Urban Internet Users	397 Mn+	546 Mn+	38%
Rural Internet Users	488 Mn+	708 Mn+	45%
Internet Penetration (Active Users) 58%	5G Enabled Indian Cities/Towns 7.7K+		
Urban Internet Penetration (Active Users) 77%	Number Of Male Internet Users 470 Mn+		
Cost Of 1 GB Internet \$0.16	Number Of Female Internet Users 416 Mn+		

Third-largest	Startup Ecosystem Globally, Measured By The Number Of Startups & Unicorns
70K+	Total Number Of Tech Startups Launched
\$161 Bn+	Total Funding Raised By Indian Startups Since 2014
120	Total Number Of Unicorns
\$650 Bn+	Combined Valuation Of Indian Startups
122	Total Number Of Soonicorns
1.6 Mn+	Total Number Of Direct Jobs Created
1.9K+	Total Number Of Active Investors
40	Total Number Of Listed New Age Tech Companies

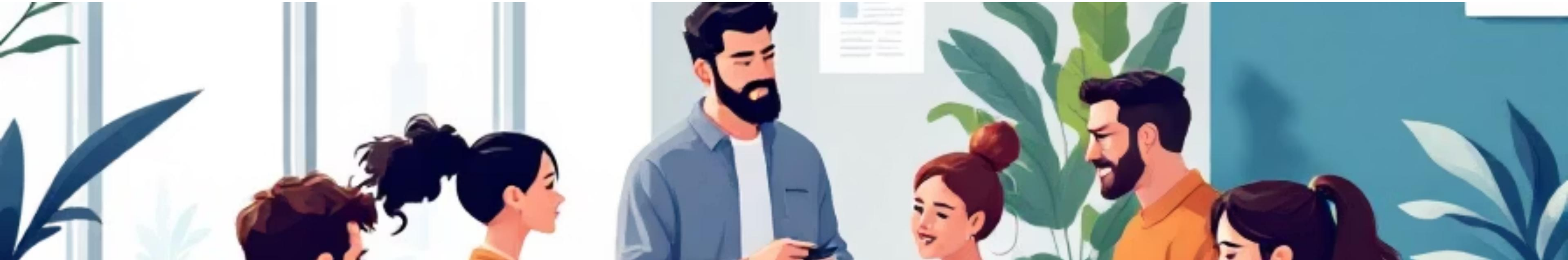
India now has large public tech companies; Overall ~100+ unicorns (\$1B+ Value)

Startups now looking to go public making liquidity easier than before

Digital companies will become a large part of India’s market cap in line with US / China trajectory



Companies have a lot to gain when Ironclad buys ESOP secondaries



Massive tool to retain and hire

By offering partial liquidity to employees in their 1st and 2nd vesting years, companies reinforce the credibility of their ESOPs and signal that wealth creation is real, not just theoretical.



Non-dilutive capital for company

ESOPs have already diluted founders and investors; providing cash liquidity does not change cap table ownership for founders / investors



Reduces cash spend

Can pay a higher portion of the total compensation via ESOPs; Employees more willing to accept it as there is a ready / willing buyer.

Providing partial liquidity make ESOP's real ! Just like equity of listed companies..

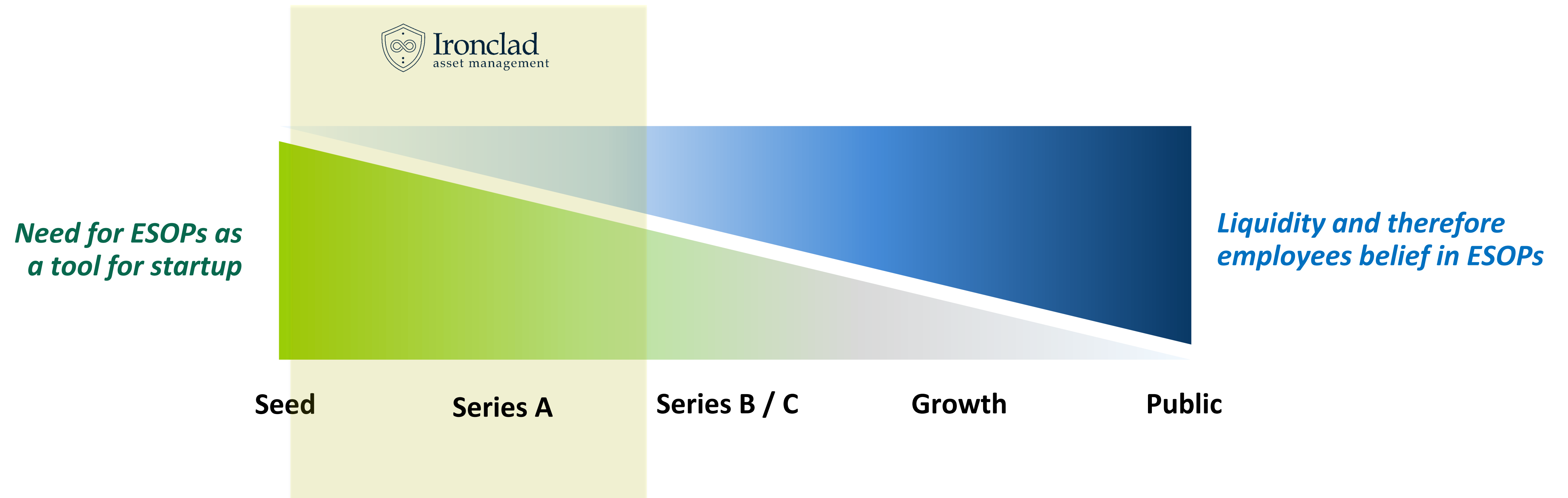
A typical tech company has ~10-12% ESOP pool; At early stage, most companies find it difficult to explain its value to employees

	Pre-ESOP	Seed	Series A	Series B	Series C	Series D	IPO
Company Valuation		\$3M	\$25M	\$150M	\$500M	\$1B	\$3B
Total Shares	10.0M	12.5M	15M	20M	25M	30M	40M
Founders	100,0%	70,0%	55,5%	38,8%	28,7%	22,7%	15,3%
Existing Investors		0,0%	15,9%	22,7%	35,3%	43,7%	40,7%
New Investors		20,0%	16,7%	25,0%	20,0%	16,7%	25,0%
ESOP - Total	0,0%	10,0%	12,0%	13,5%	16,0%	17,0%	19,0%
Allocated	0,0%	4,8%	7,4%	9,0%	11,9%	13,3%	15,8%
Unallocated		5,2%	4,6%	4,5%	4,1%	3,7%	3,2%



We provide liquidity for these ESOPs at early stage

We are not a marketplace; we are a fund and therefore buy the equity on books of fund



Thereby helping change the hiring and retention narrative



We buy ESOP's from employees of VC backed tech startups :

- Reducing cash cost of payroll as ESOP's become more efficient tool to compensate
- Making it easier to hire senior team
- Increasing retention of early employees

Overall, improves the belief that employees have on equity participation

Companies can give employee’s “x%” liquidity for their vested ESOPs, depending on liquidity framework set by the company’s board

	# vested shares	Year 1	Year 2				Year 3					Before	With Ironclad
			Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4			
Illustrative Example													
Designation : VP, Engineering													
Annual CTC	40 L	40L	10L	10L	10L	10L	10L	10L	10L	10L	Cash received by employee	40L	46L
ESOPs Granted – one time	80 L												
ESOPs Vested <i>(assuming 12 months cliff. After 12m 25% vests. 75% vests monthly or quarterly over the next 36 months)</i>		20L	5L	5L	5L	5L	5L	5L	5L	5L	Cash spent by company	40L	40L
Liquidity provided by Ironclad Ventures	30% (company decides % liquidity)	6L	1.5L	1.5L	1.5L	1.5L	1.5L	1.5L	1.5L	1.5L	Belief in remaining ESOPs in early years	Low	High

At a company level, top startups return 5x to 50x+ from Series A valuations

Current valuation of Series A investments made by top tier VC firms from 2019 to 2021

Company	Series A		Latest Round				Estimated Returns		
	Valuation	Date	# of follow-on	Current Stage	Val (\$M)	Date Latest	Time	IRR	Est MOIC
Ola Electric	277	Feb-2019	7	Series E	5,763	Jul-2023	4.4	54%	7x
Zepto	225	Oct-2021	7	Series G	5,000	Nov-2024	3.1	89%	7x
Groww	40	Jan-2019	4	Series E	3,000	Oct-2021	2.8	351%	63x
Zetwerk	33	Mar-2019	8	Series F	2,970	Dec-2024	5.8	75%	25x
BharatPe	58	Mar-2019	4	Series E	2,704	Jul-2021	2.3	293%	25x
Infra.Market	80	Dec-2019	5	Series F	2,552	Jan-2025	5.1	68%	14x
MPL	149	Jan-2019	6	Series E	2,188	Aug-2023	4.6	45%	6x
Oxyzo	1,001	Mar-2022	-	Series A	2,000	Mar-2022			2x
CoinSwitch		Jan-2021	2	Series C	1,910	Oct-2021	0.7	6,516%	23x
Spinny	25	Apr-2019	5	Series E	1,725	Nov-2021	2.6	277%	31x
OneCard	11	Jul-2019	5	Series D	1,372	Nov-2024	5.3	111%	54x
Yubi	638	Sep-2021	1	Series B	1,295	Mar-2022	0.5	200%	2x
Hasura		Jul-2019	3	Series C	1,000	Feb-2022	2.6	188%	16x
Mensa Brands	242	May-2021	1	Series B	964	Nov-2021	0.5	1,021%	3x
Observe.AI		Dec-2019	2	Series C	825	Apr-2022	2.3	111%	6x
Scaler		Jan-2020	1	Series B	710.6	Jan-2022	2.0	100%	8x
Zupee	66	Mar-2020	3	Series B	659	Jan-2022	1.8	168%	6x
Progcap	3	Apr-2019	3	Series C	600	Nov-2023	4.6	179%	111x
Khatabook		Sep-2019	2	Series C	600	Aug-2021	1.9	115%	4x
Captain Fresh	51	Jul-2021	7	Series C	522	Jan-2025	3.5	40%	3x
Apna		Aug-2020	3	Series C	500	Sep-2021	1.1	704%	10x
Absolute	66	Aug-2021	1	Series B	500	Feb-2022	0.5	3,905%	6x
Pristyn Care	146	Jan-2019	4	Series E	500	Dec-2021	2.9	22%	2x
Minimalist	77	Jul-2021	-	Series A	400	Jul-2021			5x
Smallcase	40	Feb-2019	2	Series C	350	Aug-2021	2.5	640%	149x
Credgenics	104	Jul-2021	1	Series B	340	Aug-2023	2.1	63%	3x
GoKwik	71	Sep-2021	1	Series B	323	Feb-2022	0.4	2,424%	4x
CityMall	33	Mar-2021	2	Series C	315	Mar-2022	1.0	588%	7x
WhiteHat Jr	30	Aug-2019	-	Series A	300	Aug-2019	-		10x
The Whole Truth	25	Jul-2021	2	Series C	246	Feb-2025	3.6	74%	7x
Mosaic Wellness	11	Sep-2019	3	Series A	242	Mar-2024	4.5	79%	14x
Bijnis	24	Jul-2020	1	Series B	187	Sep-2021	1.2	413%	7x
Foxtale	35	Jun-2023	2	Series C	180	Jan-2025	1.6	127%	4x

Companies have a lot to gain by partnering with Ironclad

Reduces cash burn..

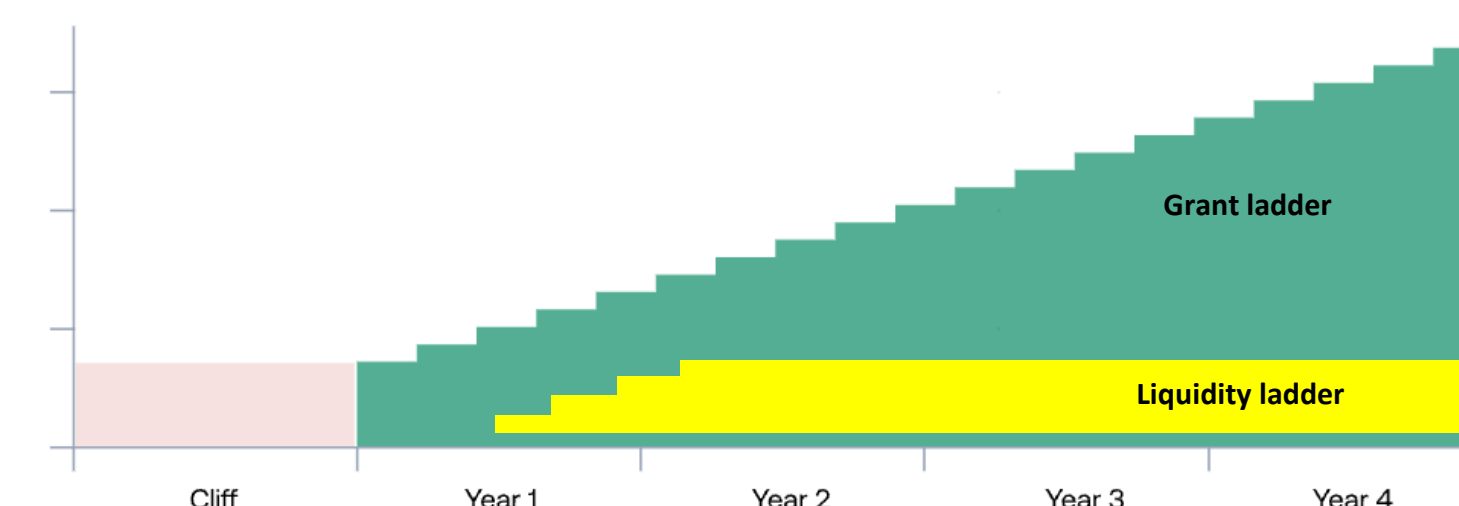
- Startups can pay a higher portion of the total compensation via ESOPs; Employees more willing to accept it as there is a ready / willing buyer.
- It increases “*in-hand cash*” for employees while reducing “*cash burn*” for companies
- Example of mid-level employee to whom with 24L fixed salary + 18L ESOPs offered

	Current	With  Ironclad asset management
Monthly Cash	2.5Lacs	2.0Lacs
Quarterly ESOP sold	Nil	4.5Lacs
Quarterly Cash in hand	7.5Lacs	10.5Lacs (9Lacs post tax)
		↑ 20%
Quarterly Cash burn for company	7.5Lacs	6 Lacs
		↓ 20%

Reduces dilution

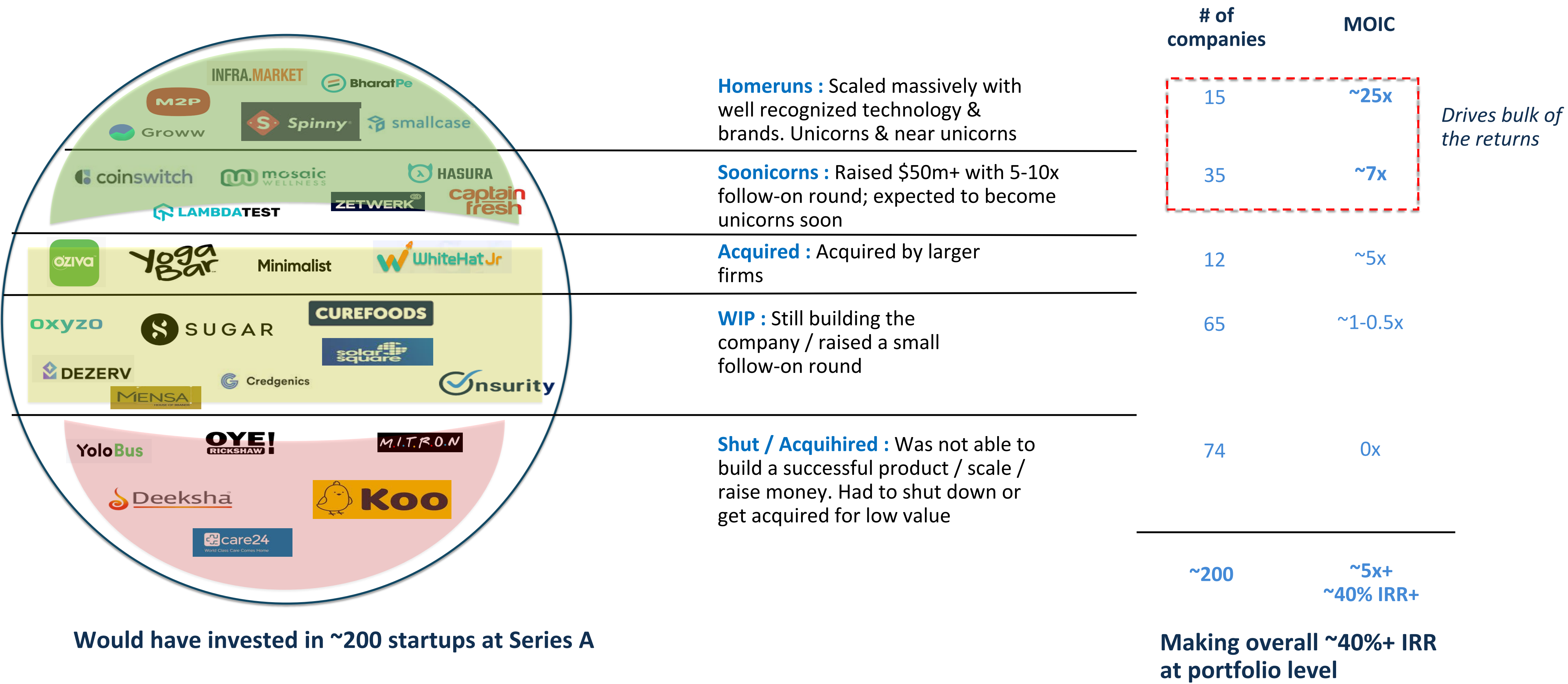
- Today, due to limited monetization opportunities, **ESOPs are often over-granted** to compensate for lack of trust in their eventual value.
- Attaching liquidity pathways startups can significantly enhance the perceived value of ESOPs and therefore meaningfully reduce grant levels.
- Liquid ESOPs also allow companies to backend the vesting and target a higher exercise price** (like public and late stage companies)
- Much lower level of grant + higher exercise price helps protect ESOP pool and reduces long term dilution
 - Junior hires with Rs. 15L illiquid ESOPs can become 5L ESOPs with liquidity.
 - Senior hires with 30bps can now be given 15bps with liquidity

Massive tool to retain and motivate

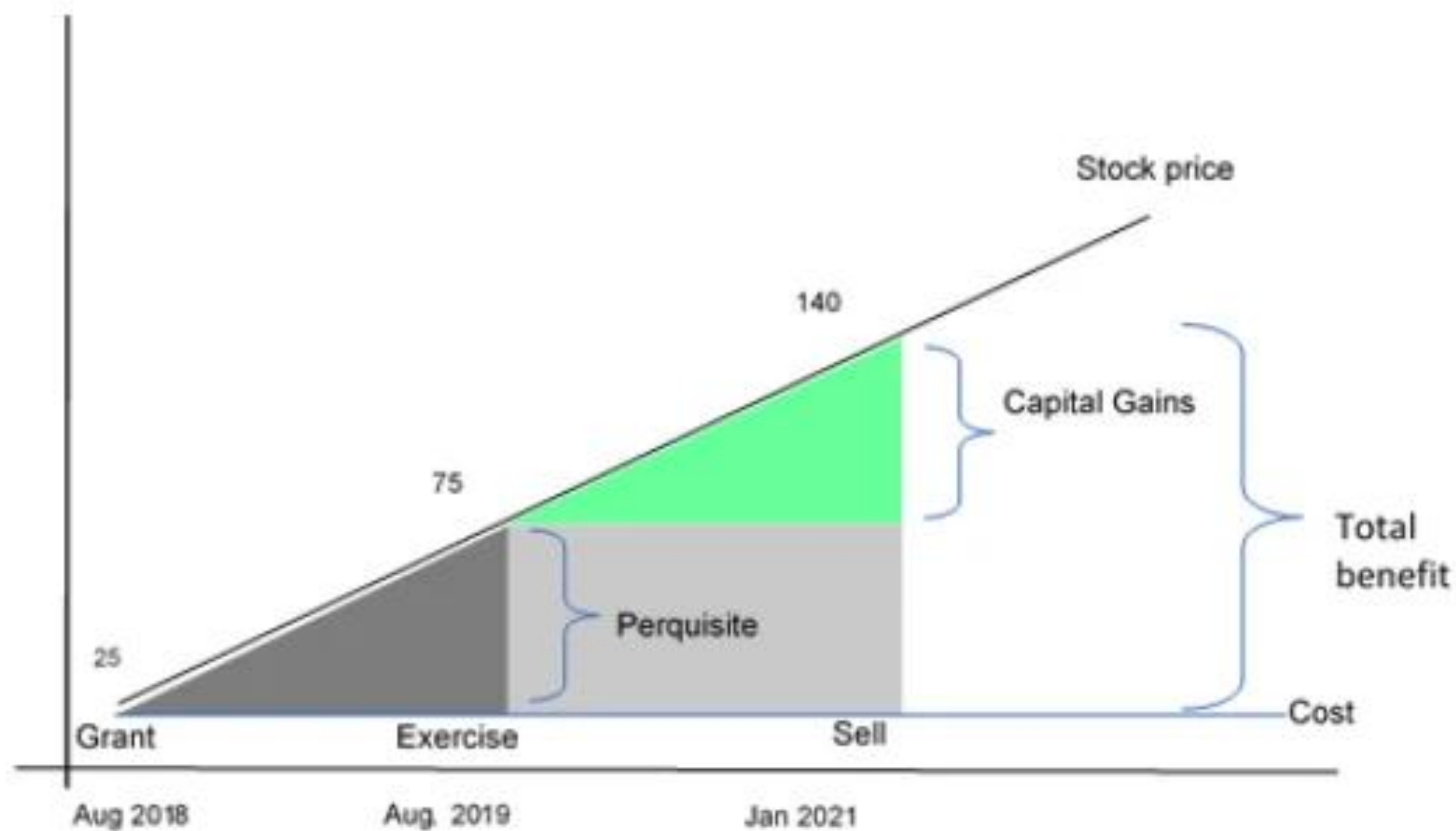


- By offering partial liquidity to employees in their 1st and 2nd vesting tranches, companies reinforce the credibility of their ESOPs and signal that wealth creation is real, not just theoretical.
- Tangible early reward builds trust and significantly increases the likelihood that employees stay through the 3rd and 4th tranches — improving long-term retention.

Back testing a co-investing @ Series A approach produces a blended IRR of ~40%+



Employees need to pay salary tax on “Perquisite” component; ~25-35% of their equity goes into paying taxes



Case Study : Fireside Ventures

MOICs are highest at early stages of investment



Fund I (2015 to 2020)

Stage	Investment	% Success (\$200m+ valuation)	MOIC (at portfolio level)
Seed	22 95Cr	~23%	10.3x
Series A	15 130Cr	~35%	7.9x
Growth (Series B & above)	7 65Cr	~50%	3.3x
			7.3x

Rs. In Crs	Seed			Series A			Growth			Total		
	Entry	Current	MOIC	Entry	Current	MOIC	Entry	Current	MOIC	Entry	Current	MOIC
Massive Success												
Honasa Consumer	4	380	100x	10	452	44x	13	103	8x	27	934	34x
Boat Lifestyle	6	301	50x	15	155	10x				21	456	22x
Transformative	11	108	10x	15	143	10x				26	251	10x
Moderate Success												
Ninety One				20	138	7x				20	138	7x
VAHDAM	0.3	7	23x	8	50	6x	22	64	3x	30	121	4x
Kapiva	14.7	107	7x	6	15	2x				21	122	6x
Design Cafe	0.3	4	14x	16	42	3x	19	23	1x	35	69	2x
Yoga Bar	14.8	35	2x	2	2	1x				17	37	2x
Bombay Shaving				7	19	3x				7	19	3x
Samosa Singh	3.1	16	5x	2	3	2x				5	19	4x
NestAway				1	7	13x				1	7	13x
Others (includes good investments, but low impact on end outcome)												
FableStreet	0.3	3	9x	0	1	4x				1	4	6x
THB	0.4	4	9x							0	4	9x
SumMor	6.0		0x	-	-					6	-	0x
eGlu	0.2	-	0x	-	-					0	-	0x
Tasty Tales	3.4	8	2x	-	-					3	8	2x
Epigamia	1.0	2	2x	-	-					1	2	2x
Delight Foods	1.3	-	0x	-	-					1	-	0x
Biosense	-	-		0	-	0x				0	-	0x
Licious	0.3	4	17x	-	-		5	5	1x	6	9	2x
Kwik24	4.6	-	0x	-	-		-	-		5	-	0x
Azani	2.7	-	0x	7	-	0x	-	-		10	-	0x
Aibono	2.1	-	0x	13	-	0x	-	-		15	-	0x
Magic Crate				7	-	0x	8	-	0x	15	-	0x
Bogorchid	3.0	-	0x	-	-		2	-	0x	5	-	0x
Curefit				-	-		5	-	0x	5	-	0x
Goodness! Beverages	8.4	-	0x	-	-			-		8	-	0x
SLAY Coffee	7.4	-	0x	1	-	0x		-		8	-	0x
Overall	95	978	10x	130	1,026	7.9	75	195	3x	301	2,200	7x
% of capital deployed	32%			43%			25%					
% Success			23%			35%						29%

Case Study : Z47

Early bets return much better MOIC than overall fund

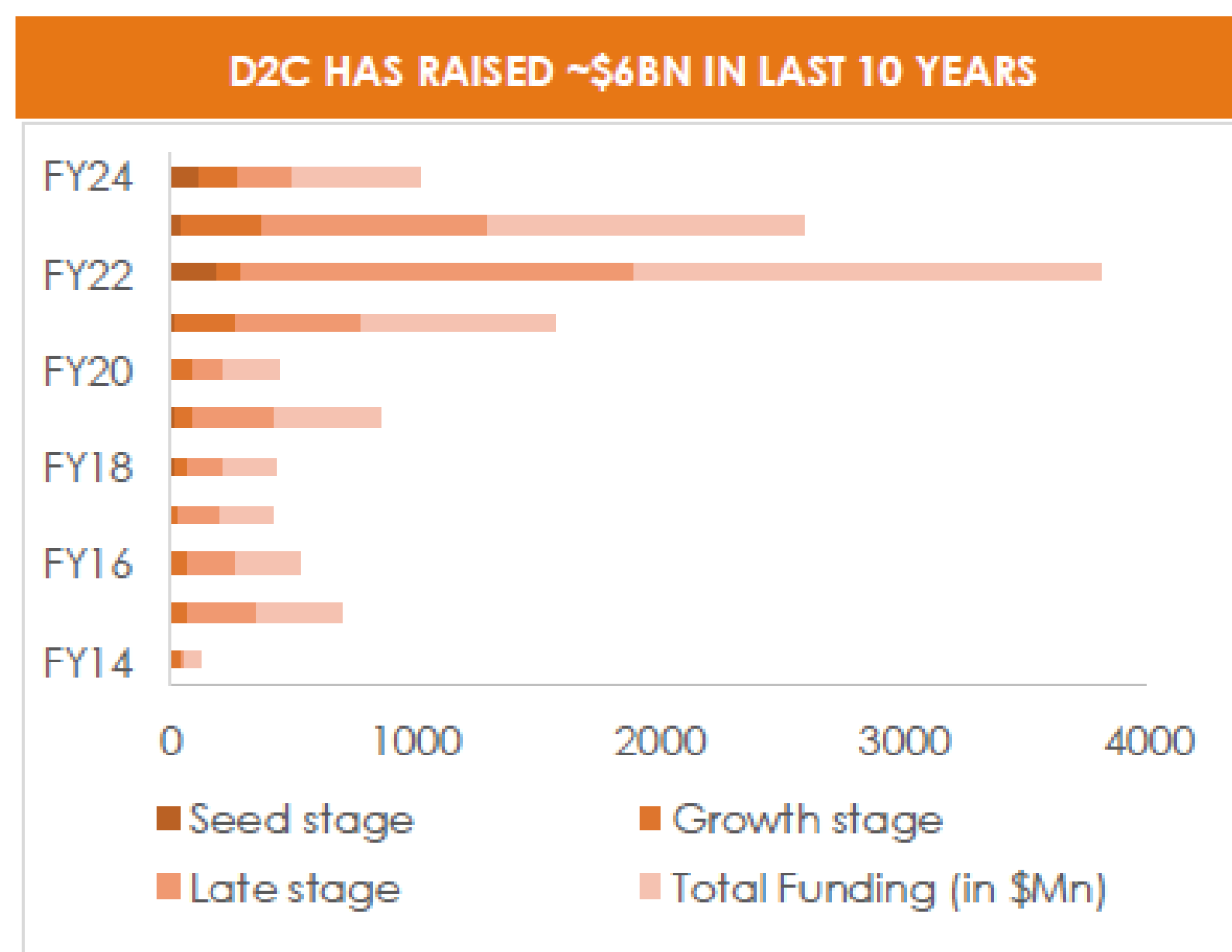
matrix a k a Z47 Fund II				
Stage	# of Cos	Investment	Current	MOIC (at portfolio level)
Early Stage (Seed + Series A)	36	~1000 Cr	~6500Cr	6.5x
Growth (Series B & above)	20 (including 15 follow-ons)	~1200 Cr	~4400Cr	3.2x
				5.0x Implies ~22% IRR for 8 yr hold

	Early Stage		Growth / Late Stage	
	Investment	MOIC	Investment	MOIC
	33	55x	8	13x
	37	51x	156	6x
	59	13x	71	5x
	6	17x	20	3x
	6	37x	81	2x
	69	4x	25	1x

Core1 : Fintech penetrating all aspects of financial value chain

	 Digital Payments	 Retail Lending	 SME Lending	 Investment and Wealth	 Insurance	 Fintech SaaS	 Neo-Banks
Total funding (\$Bn) ¹	10-11	5-6	3-4	1.5-2	3-3.5	1.5-2	1-1.2
# fintechs (>\$5Mn raised)	65-70	75-80	50-55	40-45	30-35	55-60	10-15
# fintechs (valued >\$1Bn ¹)	7	3	3	3	3	2	1
Illustrative players (Not exhaustive)	          	             	          	            	        	         	         

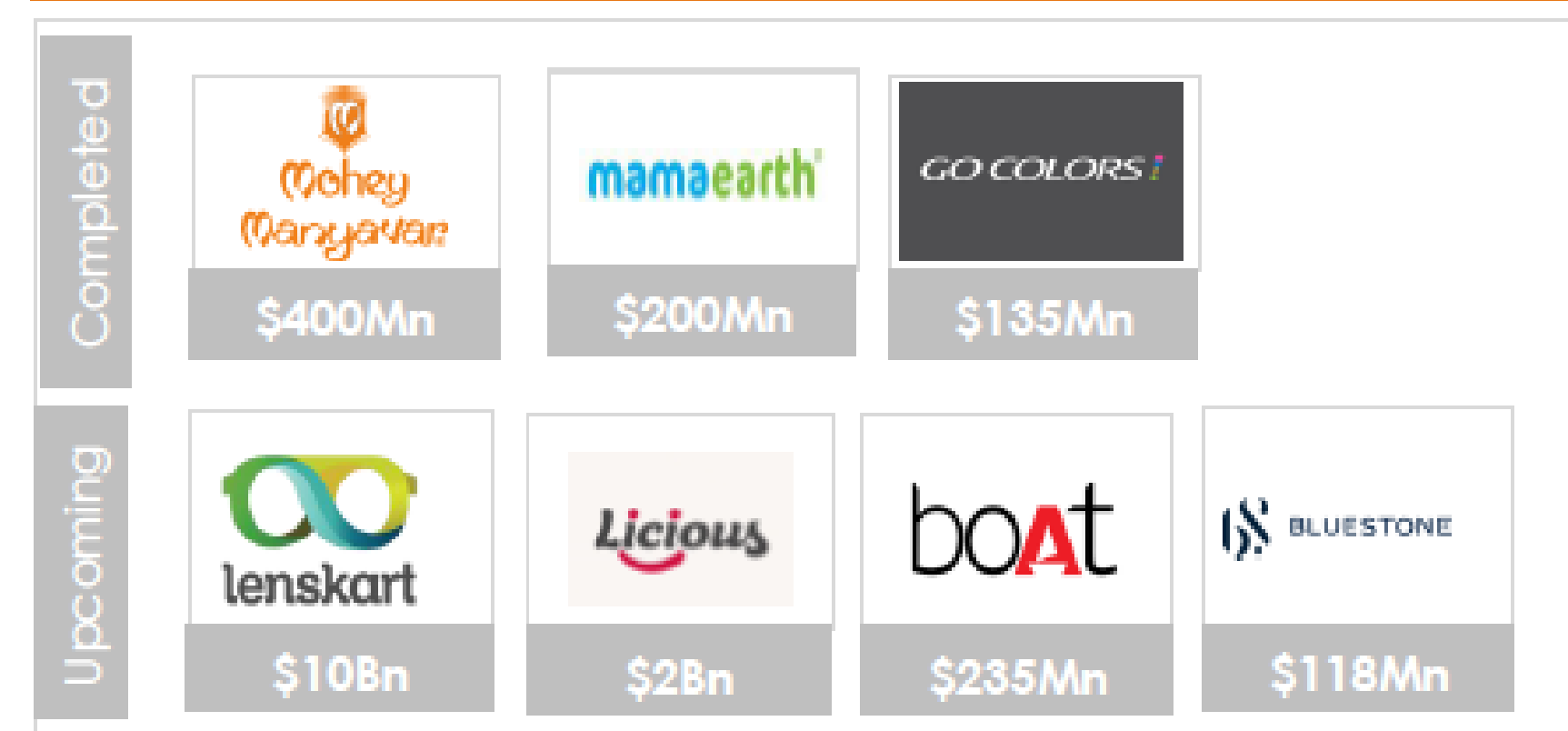
Core2 : Consumer is among the best sectors for strategic exits / IPOs



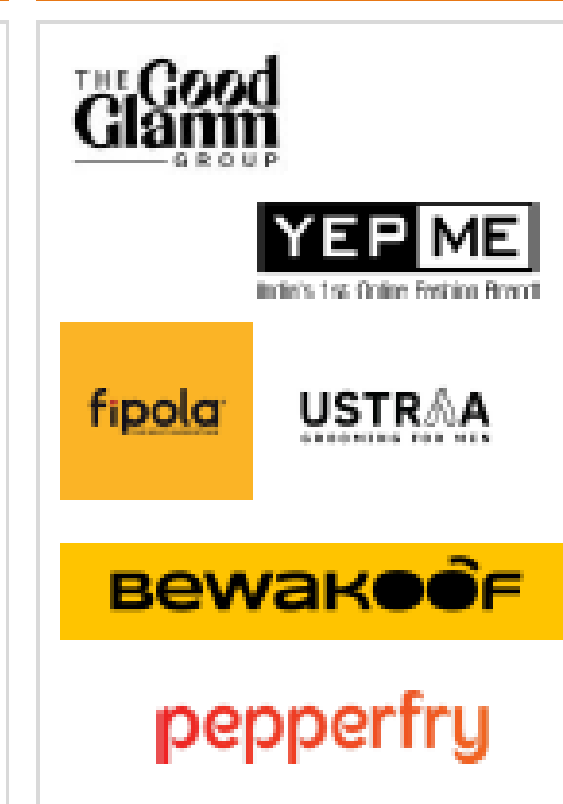
**M&A HAS BEEN MOST COMMON EXIT ROUTE..
CONSOLIDATION IN F&B & BPC SPACE EXPECTED IN COMING YEARS**



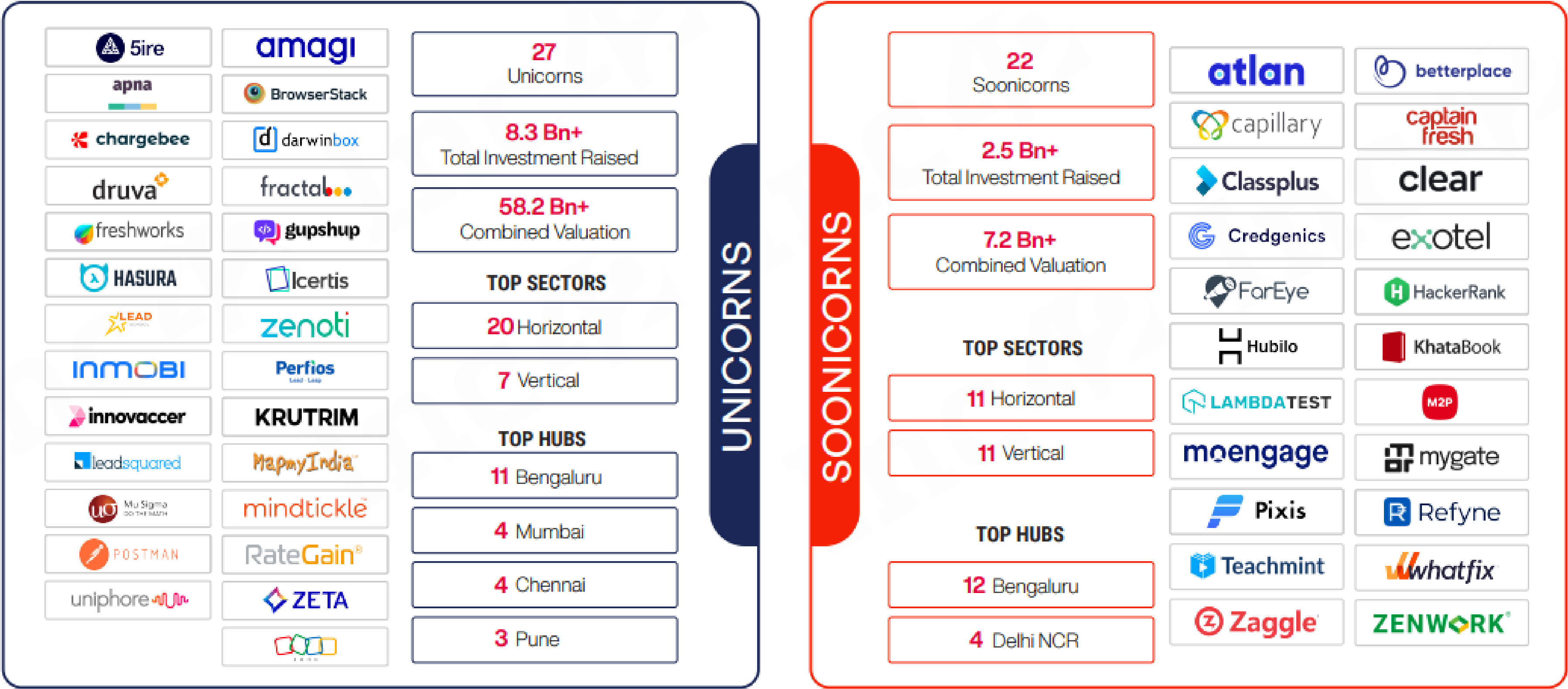
IPO HAS EMERGED AS THE NEW EXIT ROUTE



SOME FAILURES..



Core3 : India has a flourishing SaaS ecosystem; AI to accelerate this growth



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